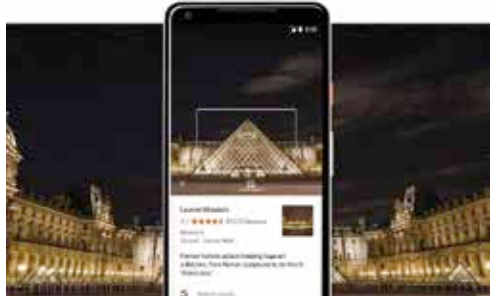


particularly the iPhone 8+ and the Samsung Galaxy Note 8. These two tied for the best ratings at 94 apiece, quite a bit higher than the Pixel's 90 (A firmware update to the camera eked out a single point upgrade over the year). And then the Pixel 2 and the Pixel 2 XL smashed that record, setting a score of 98. Smartphone photography is truly skyrocketing and pretty soon, your phone could more than suffice for most of an average customer's needs for good photos. The other internals are not so hot. Usually Pixels herald the latest and greatest in both hardware AND



Google Lens looks pretty sweet

software but this time, apparently due to the lack of chips on Qualcomm's part, the Pixel 2 shipped with regular Snapdragon 835 instead of the rumored SD 836. The Qualcomm Snapdragon 835 SoC features an octacore (up from a quadcore last year) Kryo CPU mated with 4 Gigs of LPDDR4X RAM and an Adreno 540 GPU. Not exactly groundbreaking hardware. But Android 8.0 Oreo is still plenty interesting and the Pixel 2 is going to be the first phone that ships with Oreo installed, bringing with it exciting new features like Google Lens, built in. Sundar Pichai says that the time of the war of spec sheets between flagships is over and that the new frontier is machine learning and AI but we still aren't convinced. Battery capacities are changed from last year to 2,700 mAh on the Pixel 2 (-70 mAh) and 3,520 mAh on the Pixel 2 XL(+100 mAh). An interesting detail is the squeezable sides to launch Google Assistant, which brings back a slight case of HTC U11 PTSD but at least, the whole phone isn't designed around it.

Public reception as of now seems to be a bit lukewarm, but perhaps that might change once more detailed reviews are out.

Where the Pixel 2 and Pixel 2 XL went wrong

This is significant enough to have its own section, which objectively, isn't a good thing for a new Google product to have. First thing first, Google apparently hasn't learned from its first foray into smartphone design. The Pixel 2 STILL pretty much looks like the HTC A9 and the Pixel 2 XL, at least in our